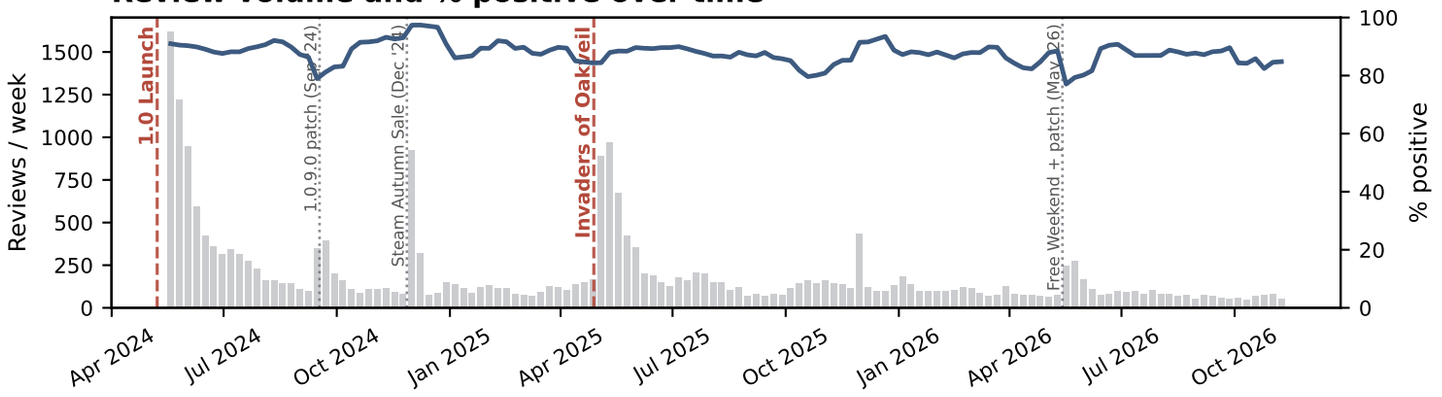
V Rising — Public Steam Review Analysis

English-language Steam reviews, 2024-05-14 to 2026-11-10 • n = 24,835 • 88% positive overall

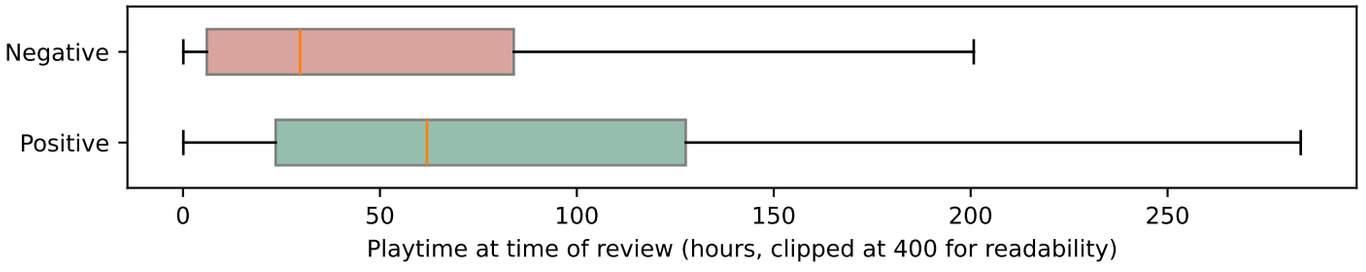
Independent fan analysis using Steam's public review data. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Stunlock Studios.

Review volume and % positive over time



Dashed red = major content updates. Dotted gray = other notable volume spikes, labeled only where verified against Steam/patch-note sources (see README); unlabeled smaller fluctuations are not individually explained. Line is a 4-week rolling % positive; weeks below 20 reviews are masked rather than shown as single noisy points, and the final partial (in-progress) week is excluded entirely.

Playtime at review: positive vs. negative



Findings

1. Positive reviews have a higher median playtime at review (62h) than negative ones (30h) — people who bounce off the game tend to say so earlier, not after a long investment.
2. Review volume spikes with each major update and decays back to baseline within roughly 6-8 weeks; % positive (4-week rolling) stays fairly stable through the same window — volume, not sentiment, is the clearer signal of an update's reach.
3. Negative reviews cluster around six recurring, nameable themes rather than being diffuse (below) — not a diagnosis of why, but a map of where to look.

Recurring themes in negative reviews

TF-IDF + NMF topic model over negative reviews only. Each line is the model's theme plus one short, clean representative phrase (not a full quote).

1. Boss fights and gear progression feel unbalanced
"→ defeat every boss available at your level → unlock better gear"

2. Updates sometimes force a new save to access new content
"save get the new content. Save on previous version? You'll be forced"

3. PvP/PvE server balance and solo-play friction
"is horrendous. Some server settings aren't even there for pure PvE players"

4. Combat and the core loop feel slow, repetitive, or grindy
"Boring. Not playing again."

5. Camera and controller control issues
"Horrible camera controls on controller."

6. Solo play feels like more of a grind than with friends
"Not as much fun as it seems."

Limitations

Steam reviewers are a self-selected, vocal subset of players, not a representative sample; this dataset is English-language reviews only; review text reflects stated opinion, not behavioral telemetry (e.g. actual churn points, session structure).

What internal telemetry could add: exact drop-off points, session length and return cadence by patch, and silent churn from players who never write a review at all.